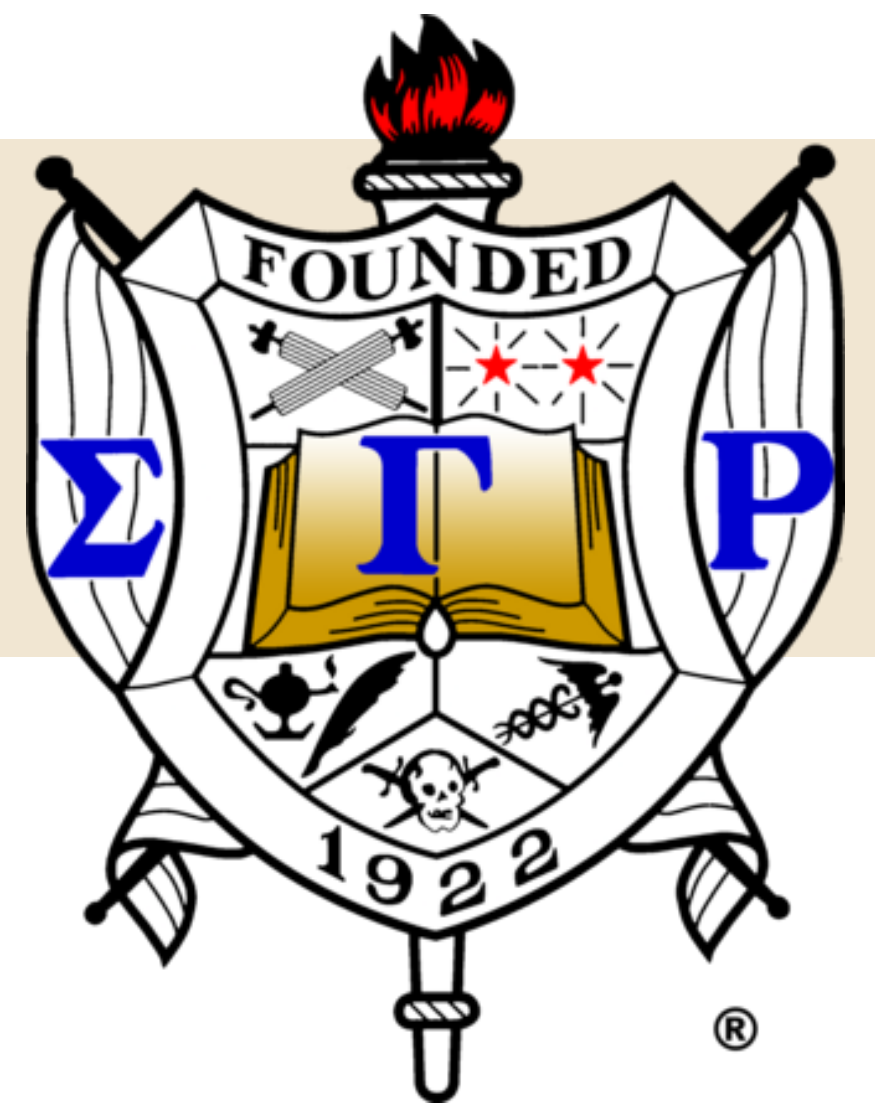


SIGMA GAMMA RHO

Butler University *Alpha Chapter*



The Seven Founders of Alpha Sigma



**BESSIE MAE DOWNEY
RHOADES MARTIN**
1897 – 1947



**MARY LOU ALLISON
GARDNER LITTLE**
Nov 2, 1896–Mar 8, 1992



**VIVIAN IRENE WHITE
MARBURY**
Mar 11, 1900 –Jul 30, 2000



CUBENA McCLURE
Feb 21, 1900–Aug 24, 1924
Host of the 1st initiation in 1922.
She passed young due to an
appendicitis operation.

Founded in 1922 and chartered in 1929, the Alpha Chapter of Sigma Gamma Rho has an extensive history at Butler University.

In 2022, “The Founders’ Plaza” was dedicated to the legacy of these academics, activists, and awe-inspiring women. While other Greek Life houses at Butler stand today, the gathering sites of these revolutionaries were often beyond the campus at personal homes. Where can we recognize the heritage sites and culture of Sigma Gamma Rho?



**HATTIE MAE ANNETTE
DULIN REDFORD**
Oct 8, 1896 –Jul 9, 1990



**DOROTHY HANLEY
WHITESIDE**
Mar 19, 1905–Jun 18, 1985



**NANNIE MAE GAHN
JOHNSON**
Jun 20, 1904–May 10, 1986

1930s. At the Home of Evelyn M. (Webb) Briscoe 2837 Boulevard Place *multiple events*

The house was **built in 1928** (L.W. Shrupp; \$6,500).

Evelyn is recorded hosting Sigma Gamma Rho
in that same year.

(21 September 1929)

Among The Greeks

SIGMA GAMMA RHO

The Alpha chapter will meet Monday at eight p. m. at the home of Soror Evelyn Briscoe, 2837 Boulevard Place. At the last meeting with Hattie Redford plans were completed for the annual children's party to be given April 1, at the Walker Casino.

(23 February 1935)



Entertains With Social Hour

Alpha Chapter of Sigma Gamma Rho entertained with a social hour Sunday, at the home of Mrs. Evelyn Briscoe in honor of Mrs. Hattie Redford, who recently completed work on her bachelor of science degree. Mrs. Redford is a teacher in the department at School No. 37.

1920s. At the Home of Bessie Geneva (Chenault) Simpson 706 N. West Street on 30 January 1926



Bessie Simpson's apartment on N. West St. today, next door to St. Philips Episcopal Church (1906). Demolished.



(30 January 1926)

Alpha Chapter of Sigma Gamma Rho Sorority thanks their friends for their assistance in making their first boulevards a success. The sorority will meet Thursday with Mrs. Bessie Simpson, 706 N. West st.



1950s. At the Home of Mildred Marshall Hall 506 W. 38th Street on 12 April 1958

(12 April 1958)

Sigmas to Make Final Dance Plans

Alpha Sigma chapter of Sigma Gamma Rho sorority will meet Saturday from noon to 1:30 at the home of the basileus, Mrs. Mildred Hall, 506 W. 38th, to make final plans for the spring dance and Central Regional Conference.

Mrs. Rosemary Carpenter will meet with the Rhoer pledge group from 10 to noon.



MILDRED HALL

Mildred hosted countless events at her home on W. 38th Street, not limited to Alpha Sigma initiations and dinner parties. She helped coordinate the 50th anniversary of Crispus Attucks' Class of 1929 at 506 as well.